

Michael Olajide Dirksen

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EDUCATION

The University of Chicago – Undergraduate Studies

B.S. in Mathematics, B.A. in Economics, & B.A. in Statistics | GPA: 3.75/4.00

Chicago, IL

Expected May 2028

The University of Chicago – Dual Enrollment Master's Program

M.S. in Financial Mathematics | GPA: 4.00/4.00

Chicago, IL

Expected May 2028

Relevant Coursework: Honors Calculus, Accelerated Analysis, Abstract Linear Algebra, Mathematical Probability, Statistical Theory & Methods, Spatial Analysis, Intro to Computer Science, Mechanics, Electricity & Magnetism, and AI Development

Honors: Jane Morton Award Nominee (2025), UChicago Humanitarian Award (2025), Jane Street GUTS++ Competition (2nd) (2025), BlackRock Academy (2025), UChicago Financial Markets Scholar (2025-28), and D.E. Shaw 'Vector' Program (2026)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Susquehanna International Group LLC

Incoming 2027 Quantitative Trading Intern

Bala Cynwyd, PA

Jun 2027 – Aug 2027

- Selected to complete an intensive quantitative trading program primarily focused on probabilistic modelling, options theory, and market microstructures. Will compete in trading games and complete desk-specific shadowing projects.

J. Goldman & Co. L.P.

Quantitative Analyst Intern

New York, NY

Dec 2025 – Present

- Built LLM embedding pipeline clustering 60,000+ internal reports into 12 features for idea-performance attribution
- Diagnosed multicollinearity between 2 MVO factors; used PCA shrinkage to cut ETF hedge churn by 5% in backtests
- Built PM analytics tools covering ~100K positions, surfacing style patterns and trade-process caveats across 40+ PMs

Booth School of Business – [Prof. Dacheng Xin](#)

Quantitative Research Assistant ([Expected Returns and LLMs](#))

Chicago, IL

Mar 2025 – Present

- Built a Python scraper for 3 prediction market APIs, pulling data for >1M market contracts from the last 5 years
- Tested 100+ LLM prompt/parameter settings on Midway, plotting 3-D surfaces of model prediction sensitivity
- Built Midway batch jobs over WRDS reports from 15 banks; parsed 250+ batches for OOS portfolio backtesting

Wespath Institutional Investments

Investment Management Intern

Chicago, IL

May 2025 – Aug 2025

- Analyzed eVestment and FactSet data, actively supporting the reallocation of 84% of a \$28B equity portfolio
- Presented attribution at 3 of 9 investment committee meetings, discussing notes on external hedge fund managers
- Piloted 4 projects utilizing Salesforce, MS Copilot, and Python-based automation, improving workplace efficiency

LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

Maverick SMF – \$80,000 student-managed equities portfolio

Head of Quantitative Strategies & Industrials Portfolio Manager

Chicago, IL

Mar 2025 – Present

- Contributed to an ML-based language processing Python script to analyze sentiment through earnings calls and 10-Ks
- Developed baseline ARIMA and GARCH models for return forecasting, iteratively augmenting with predictive signals
- Oversee education for ~15 quantitative and fundamental traders through portfolio optimization and trading projects

Derivatives Group Quant Trading (DGQT)

Board Member & VP of Finance

Chicago, IL

Dec 2024 – Present

- Taught two 3-hour courses to 80+ undergraduate students, covering options basics and introductory probability
- Assisted in creating a 9-week 'Theory of Options' cohort, writing lecture notes and questions for ~20 students

UChicago Behavioral Economics Association

VP of Finance & Research Project Lead

Chicago, IL

Sep 2024 – May 2026

- Managed a \$7,000 club budget to organize and fund events to promote education and networking for 70+ members
- Taught ~25 students a 3-part quantitative behavioral economics series on trade timing, biases, and ML in investing

UChicago Trading Competition – Portfolio Team

Quantitative Strategy Developer

Chicago, IL

Mar 2026 – Apr 2026

- Led research on 15-year in-sample data, measuring effectiveness of AR/MA models net of transaction costs
- Collaborated on a regime detection model for multi-sleeve allocation tilts; producing a 2.36 in-sample Sharpe

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Programming: Python (pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, matplotlib), SQL, R, LaTeX, Git

Tools: Bloomberg, FactSet, LSEG, WRDS, MS Office Suite, Power Automate, GitHub, VS Code, PyCharm, Midway3

Interests: Football (Steelers), Fantasy Sports, Olympic Sprinting, Poker (PLO, NLHE), Billiards, Good Food